



LABORATORY ACTIVITY NO. 1.4.5

Managing User Accounts

This lab activity focuses on familiarizing users with the essential features for managing user accounts within **Windows 11**. It guides participants through the process of setting up and managing sign-in options, including adding a PIN for quick access. The lab also covers the creation of new local user accounts, demonstrating how to add a new user without a Microsoft account and how to set up their initial credentials and security questions. Furthermore, it addresses how to switch between different user accounts, as well as how to remove accounts and their associated data from the system, emphasizing the administrative control over user access.

I. OBJECTIVES

Upon completion of this laboratory exercise, students are expected to and meet the following intended learning outcomes:

Activity Objectives	Intended Learning Outcomes		
	ILO1	ILO2	ILO3
1) implement and manage various user account sign-in options, such as creating and removing PINs.	•	•	
2) create and configure new local user accounts on a Windows operating system without a Microsoft account.	•	•	•
3) understand and perform the necessary steps to manage and delete existing user accounts and their associated data.	•	•	

Where:

- ILO1 – Exhibit thorough demonstration of the concept
- ILO2 – Being able to perform the activity independently
- ILO3 – Design and evaluate emerging IT solutions

II. DISCUSSION

- **Management Interfaces:**
 - **GUI Tools:** Windows provides various snap-ins (specialized management tools) accessible through the Microsoft Management Console (MMC) or standalone applications for system management.
 - **Command Line Interface (CLI):** Powerful text-based interfaces such as Windows PowerShell, Command Prompt (for Windows), and Bash (for Linux) allow for efficient OS management.



- **Computer Management Console:** This comprehensive administrative console provides a centralized point of access to several "snap-ins" for system administration, including:
 - Task Scheduler for automating tasks.
 - Event Viewer for reviewing system and application logs.
 - Shared Folders for managing network shares.
 - Local Users and Groups for managing user accounts and security groups on the local machine.
 - Performance Monitor for analyzing system performance data.
 - Device Manager for managing hardware devices and their drivers.
 - Disk Management for configuring disk drives and partitions.
 - Services for managing background processes and system services.
- **Windows Settings and Control Panel:**
 - **Settings App:** The modern interface for configuring various aspects of Windows, categorized into sections like System, Devices, Network & Internet, Personalization, Apps, Accounts, etc.
 - **Control Panel:** The traditional interface, which still contains advanced configuration options and legacy tools not yet fully integrated into the Settings app (e.g., Administrative Tools, Programs and Features).
- **Access Control and Protection:** This feature ensures that only authorized users can access computer systems, networks, and data. Users are identified via accounts and must authenticate with credentials unique to them. Accounts are assigned specific privileges or rights defining what actions they can perform.
- **Account Types and User Account Control (UAC):**
 - **Administrator Accounts:** Possess full control over the operating system, allowing for system-wide changes.
 - **Standard User Accounts:** Have limited privileges, designed to protect the system from unauthorized or accidental changes.
 - **Principle of Least Privilege:** A security best practice that advocates assigning the minimum necessary rights and permissions to user accounts.
 - **User Account Control (UAC):** A security feature that prompts for explicit administrator authorization before allowing significant system changes, even if the user is logged in as an administrator, to prevent malicious software from making unauthorized modifications.
- **Creating and Managing User Accounts:** Discussions cover the differences between cloud-based Microsoft accounts and local accounts (which are device-specific). It also mentions using the Account settings app for basic management (e.g., changing passwords) and the Local Users and Groups snap-in for more advanced local account configurations.



III. MATERIALS

A Windows 11 installed computer system.

IV. PROCEDURE

For this activity, you will execute the provided step-by-step instructions. As you complete each step, capture a screenshot of the resulting output or completed action that directly demonstrates successful execution of that instruction. Paste each screenshot into the designated area within your lab document.

Important Considerations:

- **Operating System Differences:** Considering students' familiarity with Windows 10, the core concepts of user account management remain consistent. The **Windows 11 user interface for settings (specifically the "Accounts" section)** and the navigation flow for adding/removing users will differ in appearance and menu locations.
- **Administrator Privileges:** Most account management tasks, such as adding new users, changing account types, or removing existing accounts, **require administrator privileges**. You must be logged in as an administrator to successfully complete all steps in this lab.
- **PIN Setup and Security:** The lab demonstrates setting up a PIN for sign-in. While a PIN offers quick access, remember it's typically device-specific. For real-world scenarios, always use strong, unique answers for security questions, as the lab simplifies them for demonstration purposes.
- **Local vs. Microsoft Accounts:** The lab focuses on creating a **local user account**. Windows 11 often promotes the use of Microsoft accounts for cloud integration and features. Understand the distinction between these two account types and choose based on your actual needs.
- **Data Loss during Account Deletion:** Be aware of the explicit warning: **deleting a user account will result in the permanent loss of all associated user data and files**. Always back up any critical data before proceeding with account deletion, as this action is irreversible.
- **Navigation to Other Accounts:** In Windows 11, the section for managing other user accounts is typically found under **Settings > Accounts > Family & other users** (or "Other users" depending on the version and configuration).
- **Sign-out and Switching Users:** The lab involves signing out of one account and signing into another. This process is crucial for observing the effects of account management changes and confirming proper access control.

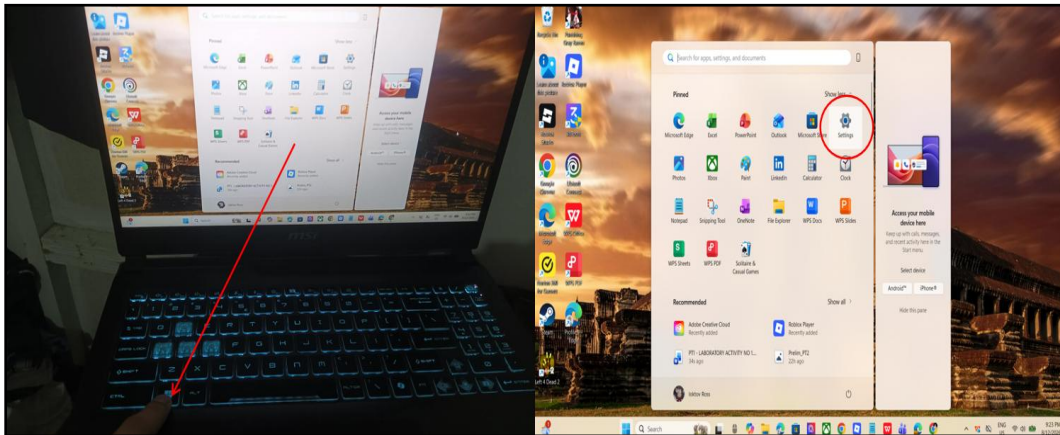


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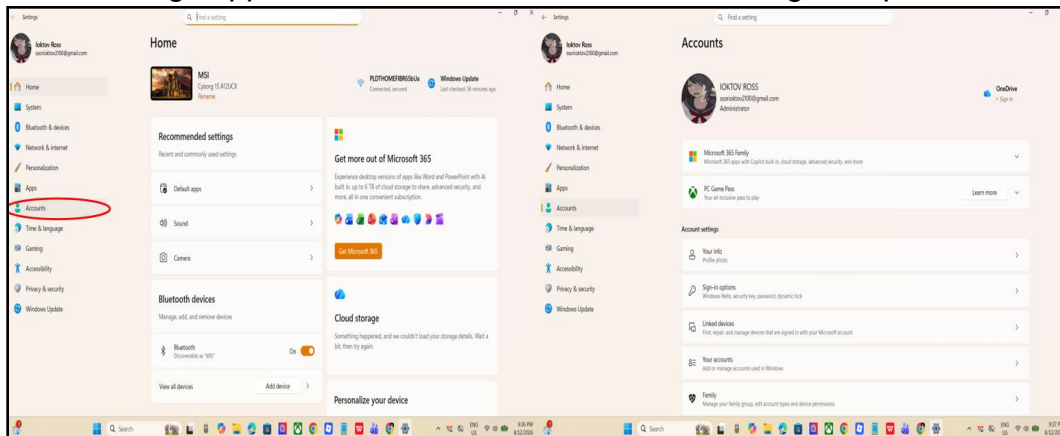
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Steps:

1. Click the **Start** button (typically centered on the Taskbar) and then click the **Settings** icon (a gear icon).

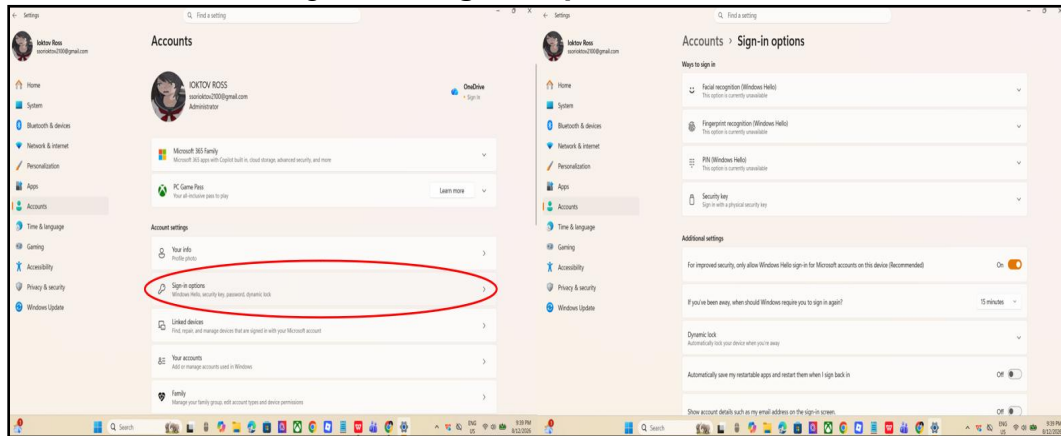


2. In the Settings app, click **Accounts** in the left-hand navigation pane.

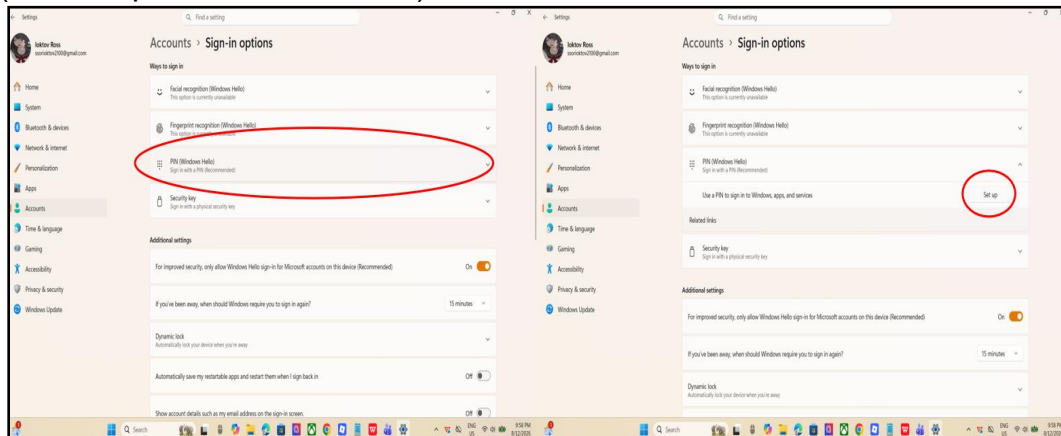




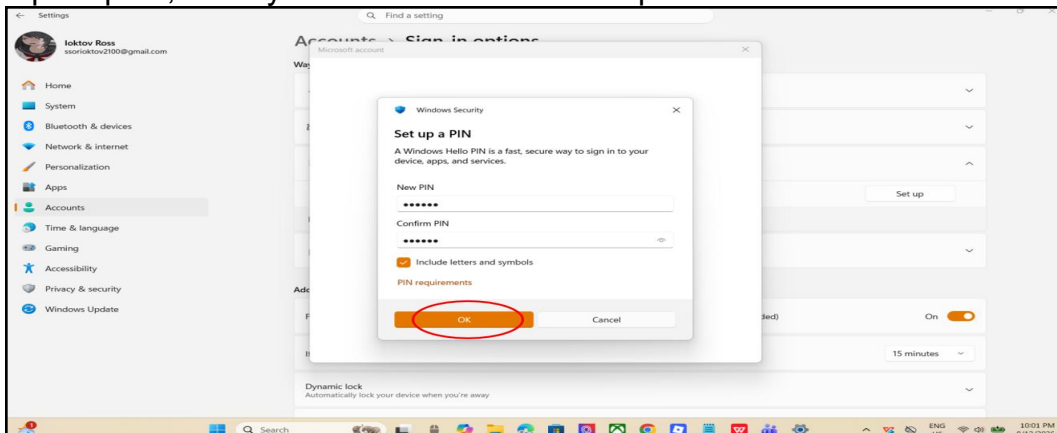
3. In the Accounts settings, click **Sign-in options**.



4. Under the "Ways to sign in" section, locate **PIN (Windows Hello)** and click **Add** (or "Set up" if it's the first time).

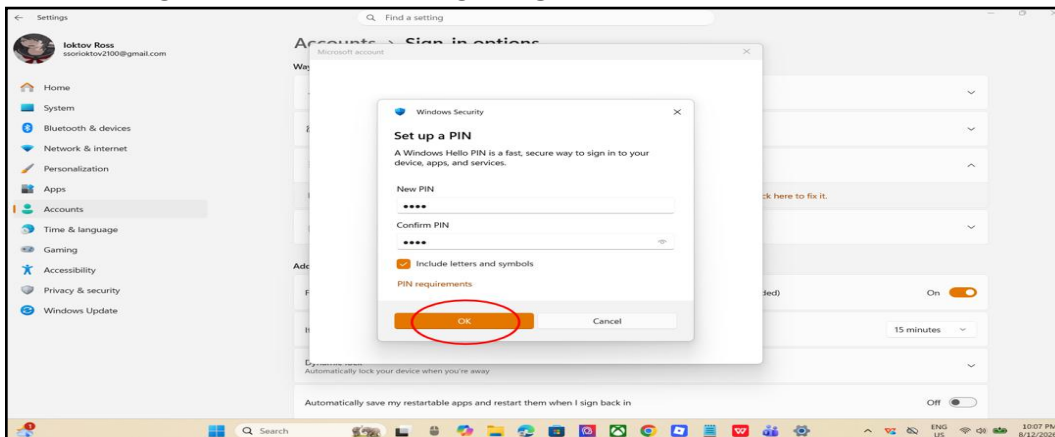


5. If prompted, enter your current user account password and click **OK**.

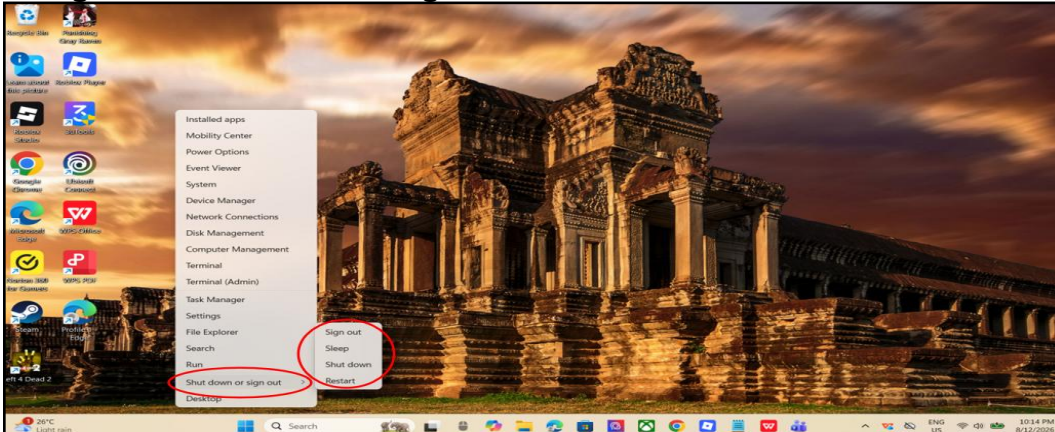




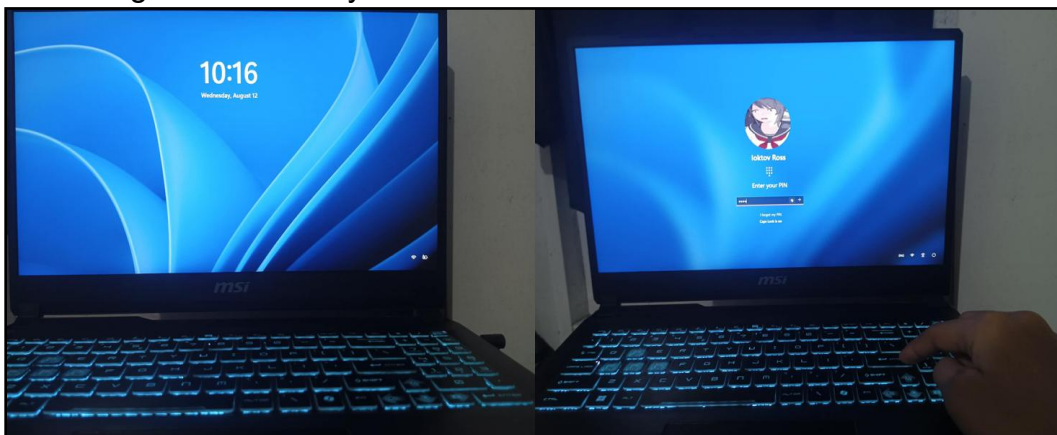
6. In the "Set up a PIN" window, enter your desired four-digit PIN in both the "New PIN" and "Confirm PIN" boxes. Click **OK**.



7. **Sign out of your account:** Right-click the **Start** button, hover over **Shut down or sign out**, and then click **Sign out**.

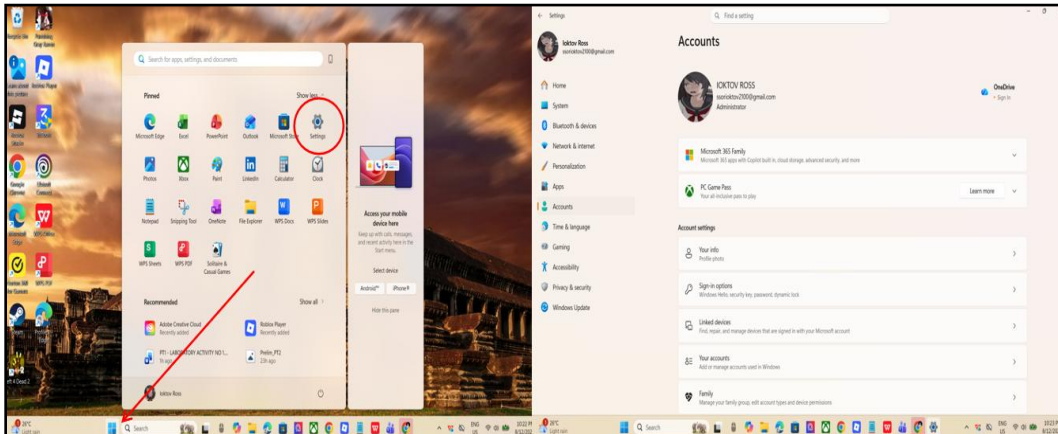


8. **Sign in with your PIN:** When you reach the lock screen, press a key or click to dismiss the privacy shade. In the PIN box, type your four-digit PIN. You should now be signed back into your account.

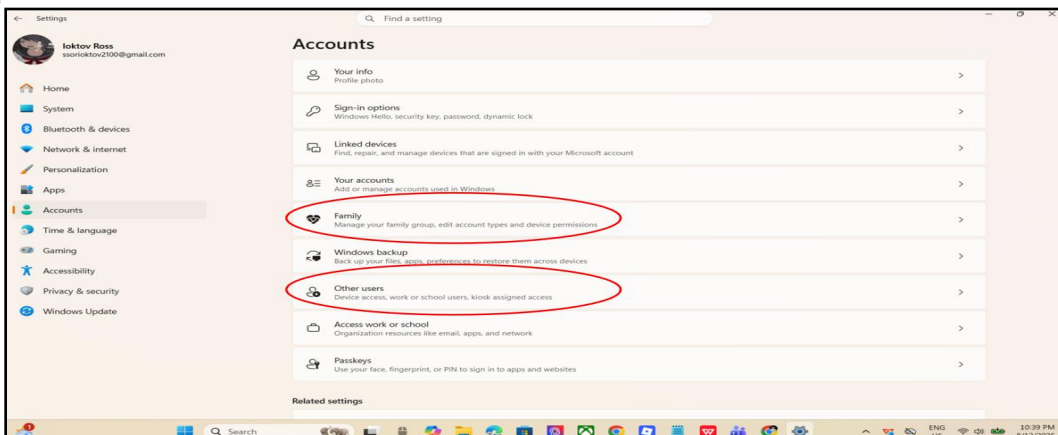




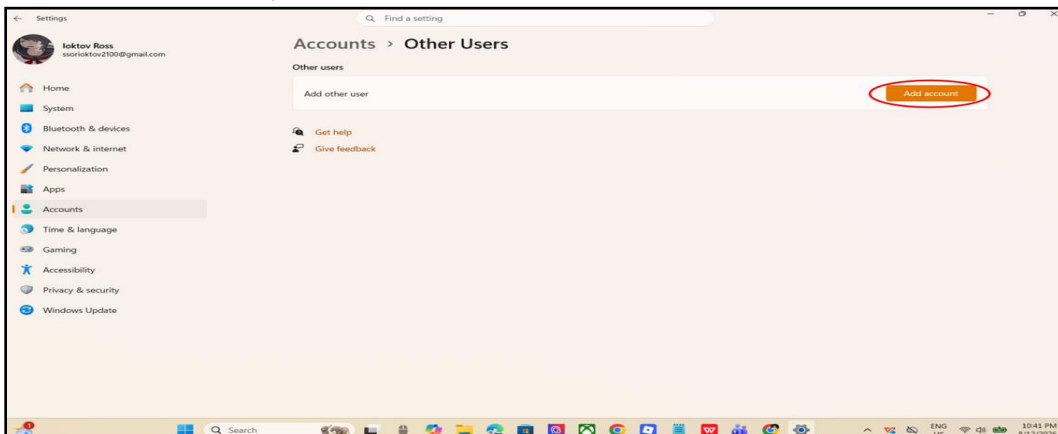
9. **Open Accounts Settings again:** Click the **Start** button and then the **Settings** icon, then click **Accounts**.



10. In the Accounts settings, click **Family & other users** in the left-hand navigation pane.

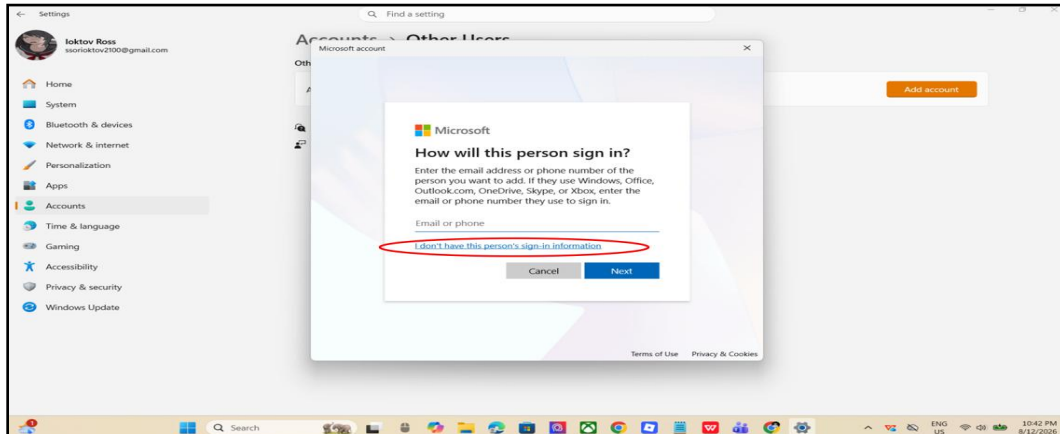


11. Under "Other users," click **Add account**.

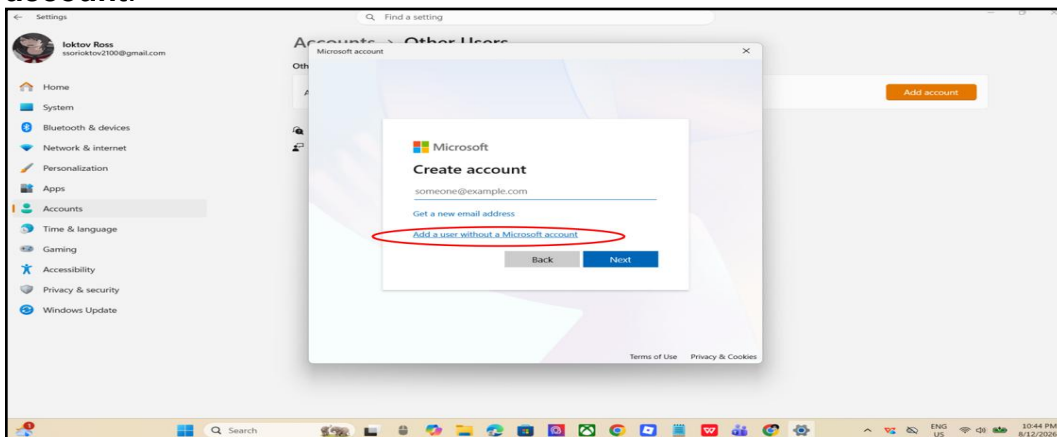




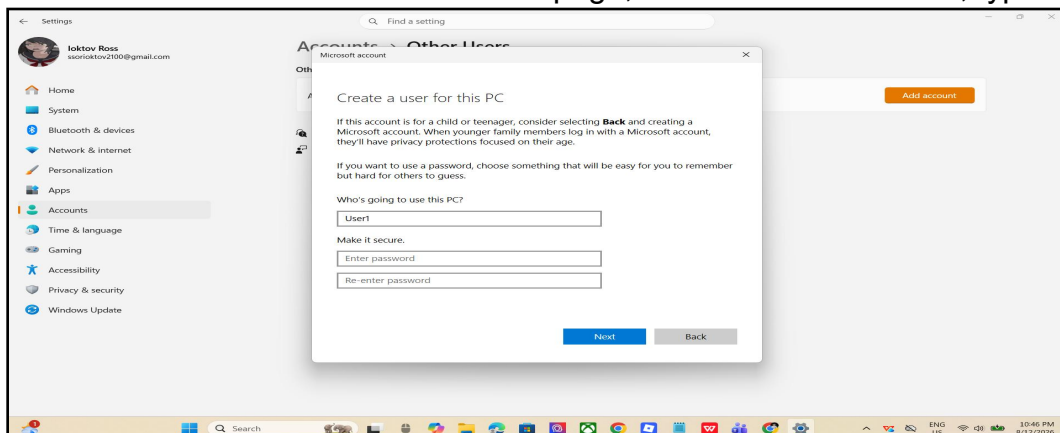
12. In the "How will this person sign in?" window, click the option **I don't have this person's sign-in information**.



13. On the "Let's create your account" page, click **Add a user without a Microsoft account**.

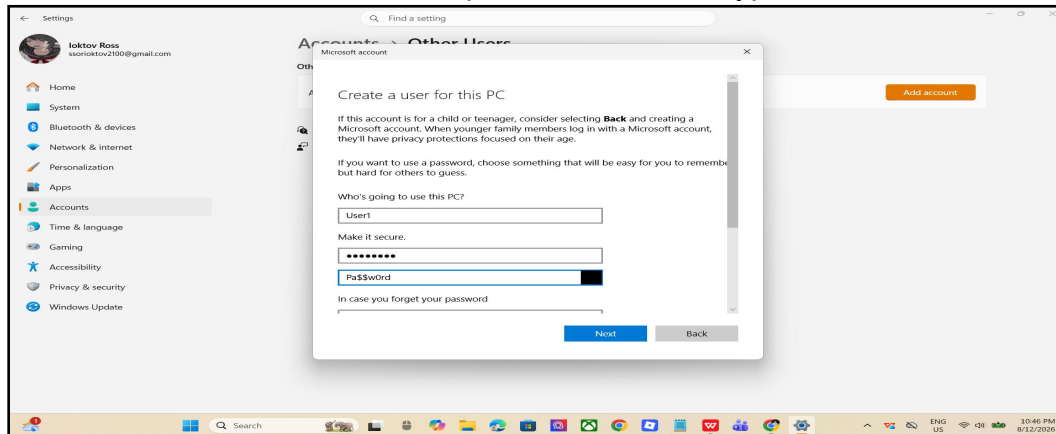


14. On the "Create an account for this PC" page, in the "Username" box, type User1.



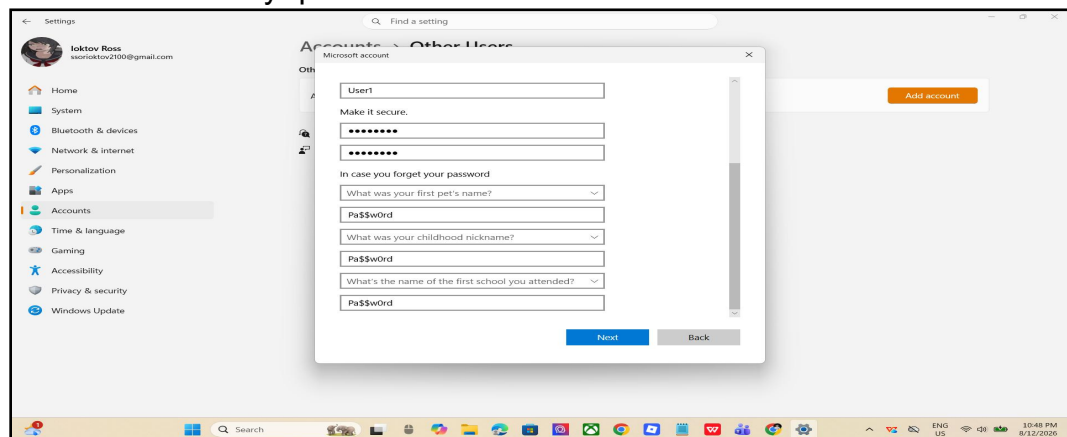


15. In the "Password" and "Re-enter password" boxes, type Pa\$\$w0rd.

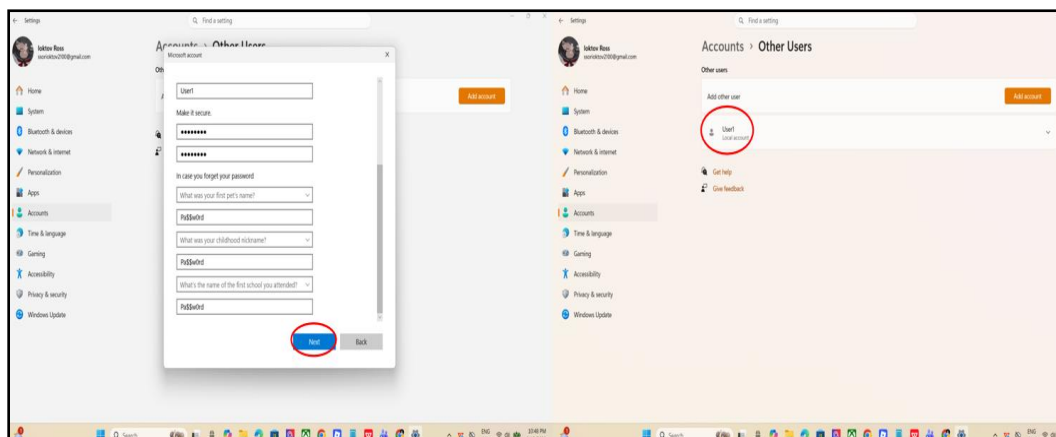


16. For the "Security questions" boxes, for simplicity in this lab, just enter Pa\$\$w0rd as the answer for each of the three questions.

- **Note:** In a real-world scenario, you should always set strong, unique, and memorable security questions and answers.



17. Click **Next** to create the account. You will now see "User1" listed under "Other users."

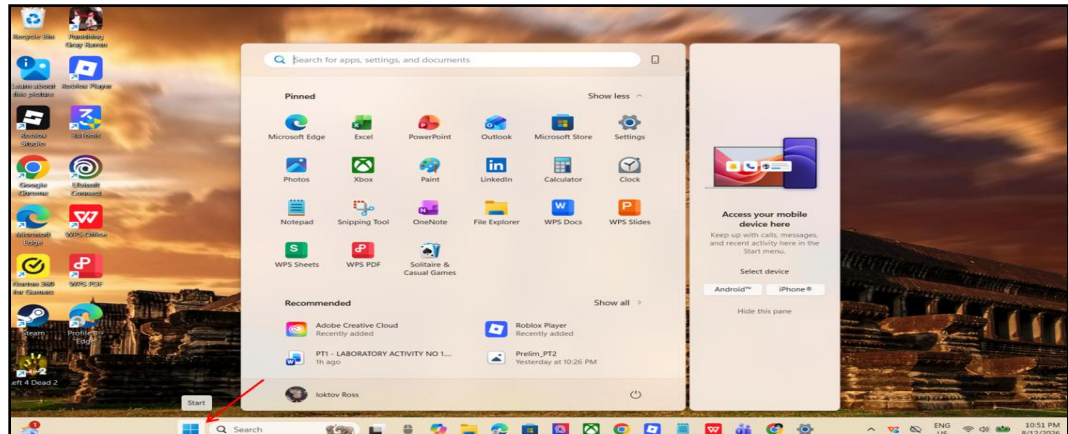


18. Switch to the new user account:

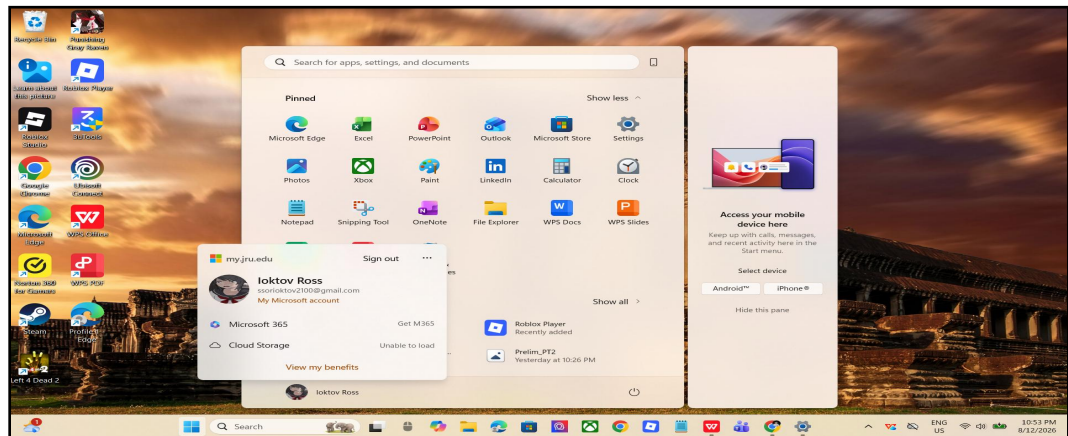


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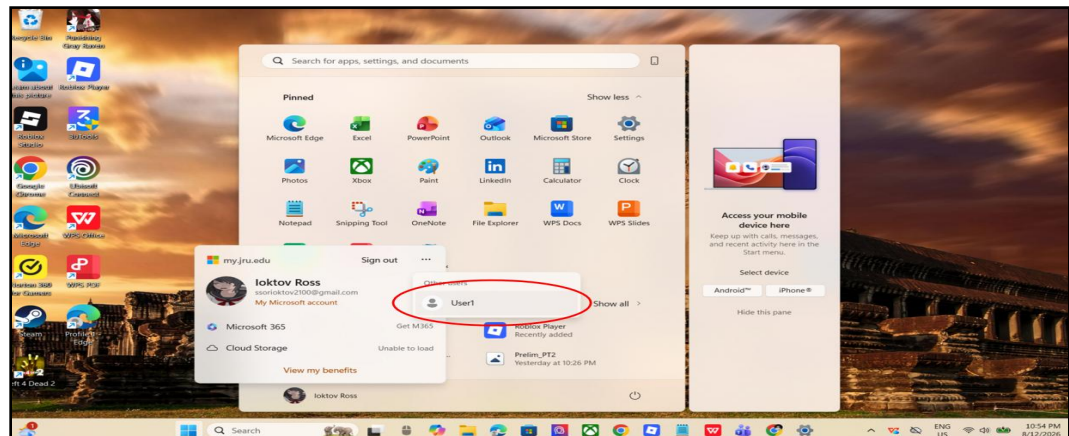
- Click the **Start** button.



- Click your current user profile picture/icon located at the bottom left of the Start menu.



- Click **User1** from the list of accounts.

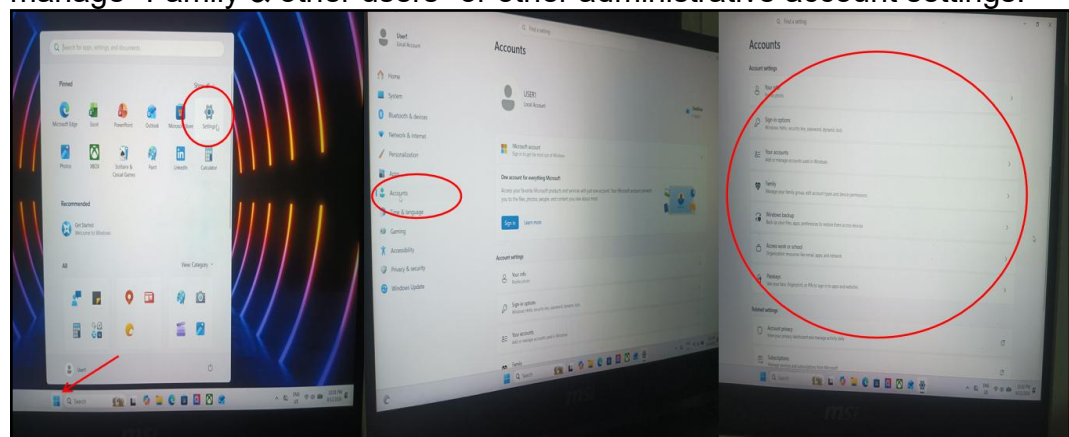


19. At the sign-in screen for User1, enter Pa\$\$w0rd in the password box and press ENTER. Wait while Windows 11 builds the profile for the new account.



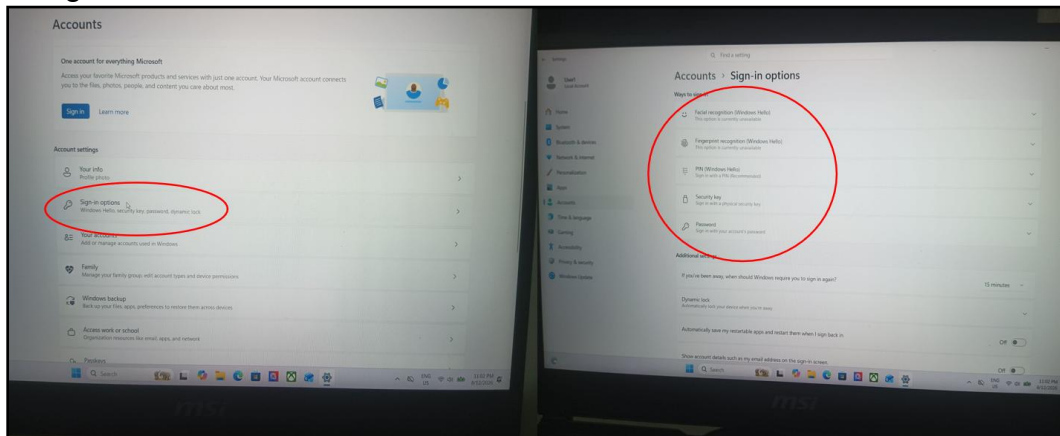
20. Once signed in as User1, open the **Settings** app and then select **Accounts**.

- **Note:** From a standard user account, you will typically not see options to manage "Family & other users" or other administrative account settings.

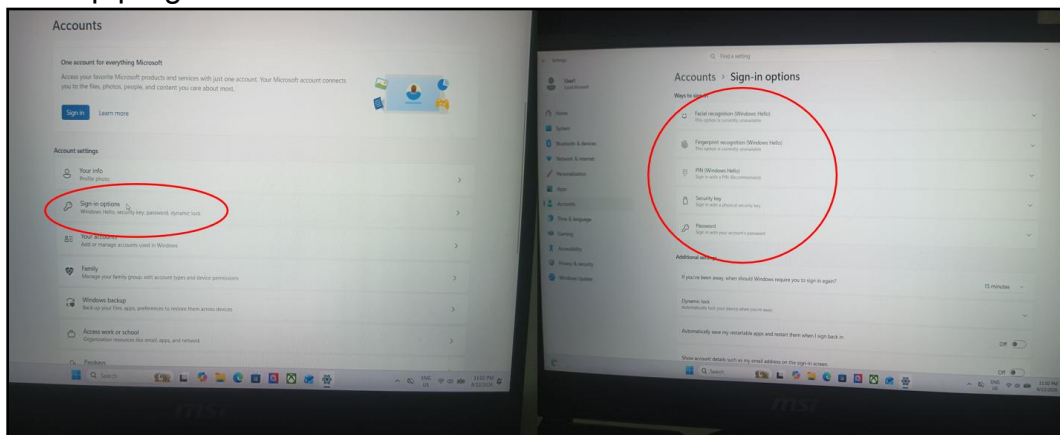




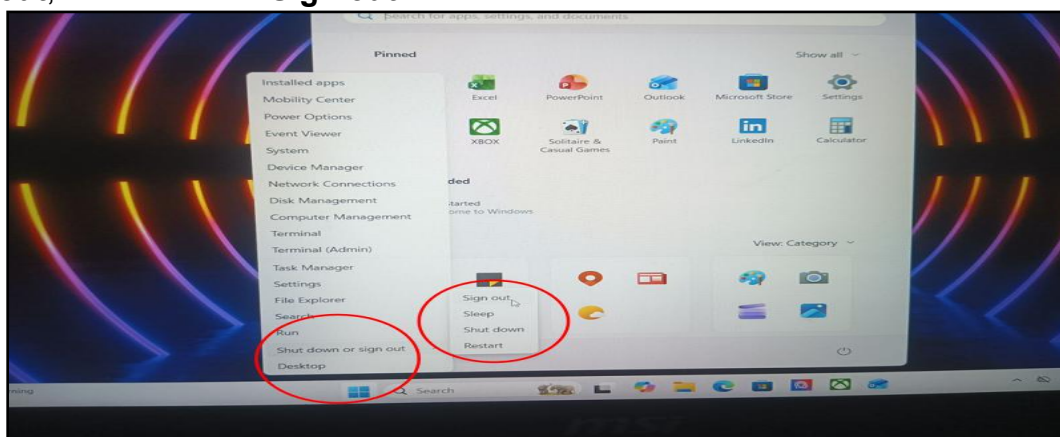
21. Click the **Sign-in options** page. You can observe the available options to configure authentication methods for this account.



22. Open **Microsoft Edge** and view a few websites, then open some other apps or desktop programs.

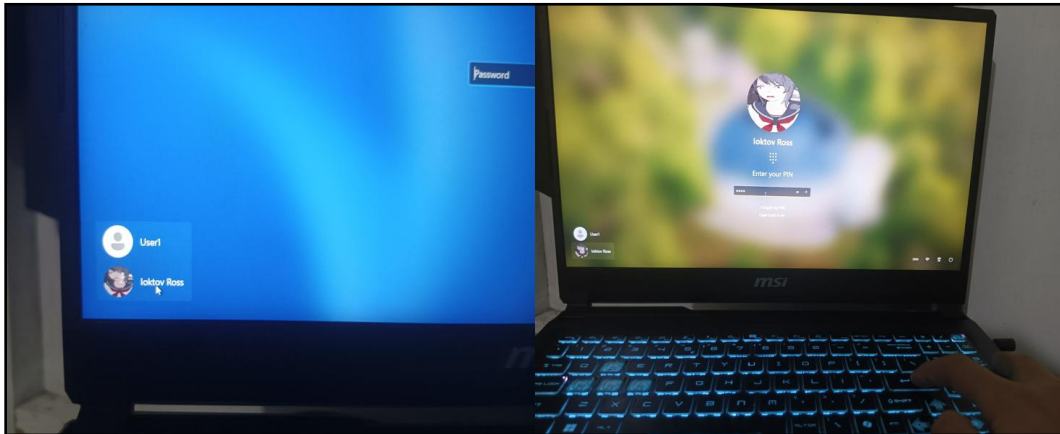


23. **Sign out of User1:** Right-click the **Start** button, hover over **Shut down or sign out**, and then click **Sign out**.



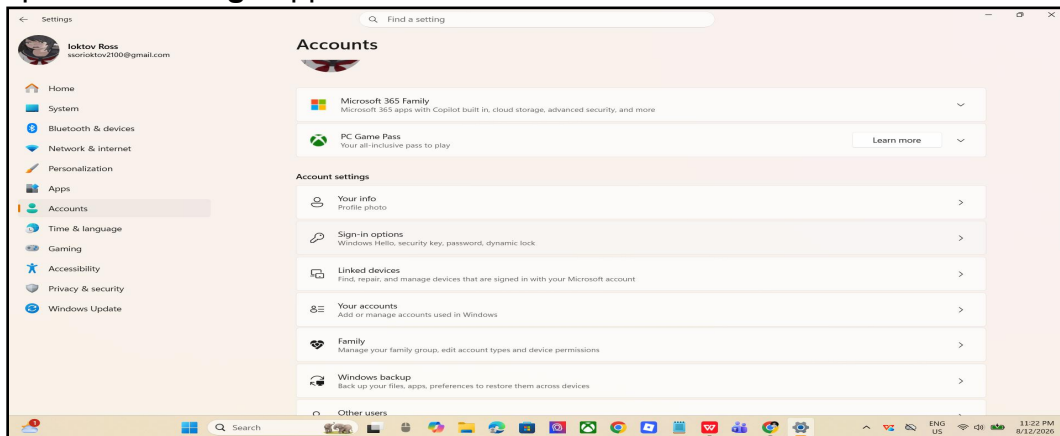


24. Sign back into your primary account by entering your PIN.



To complete this lab, we will reverse the changes you made:

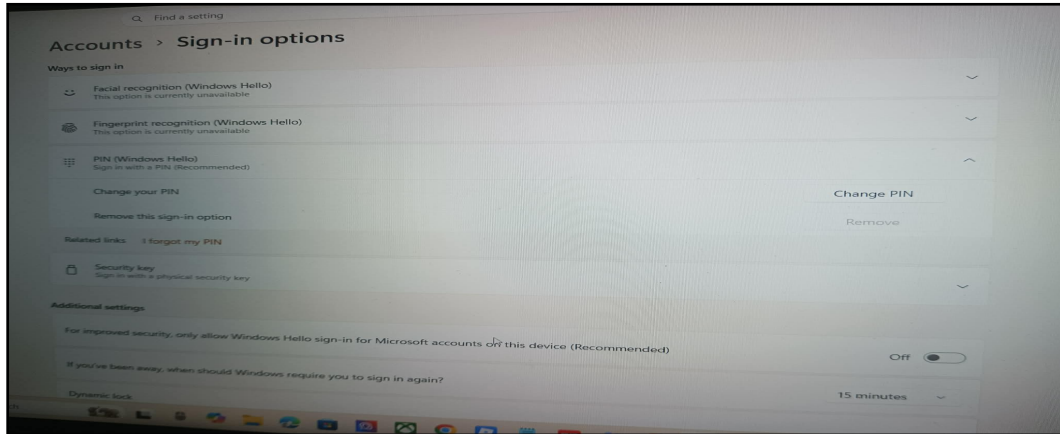
25. Open the **Settings** app and then select **Accounts**.



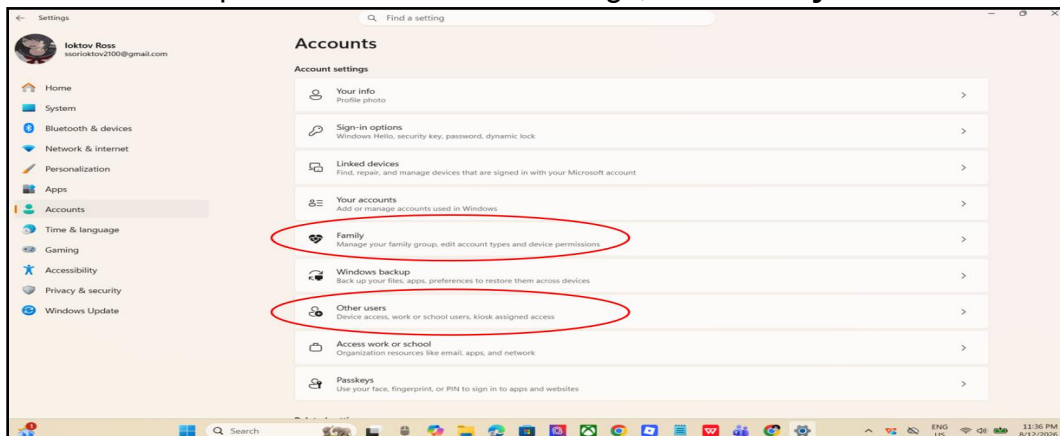
26. In the left-hand pane, click **Sign-in options**. Under the "Ways to sign in" section, locate **PIN (Windows Hello)**. Click the **Remove** button, and then confirm by clicking **Remove** again. You will be prompted to enter your primary account



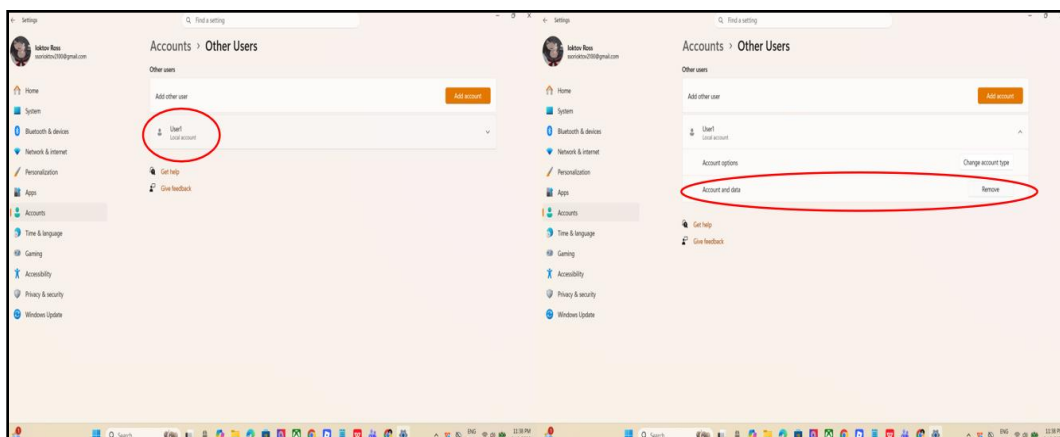
password to verify.



27. In the left-hand pane of the Accounts settings, click **Family & other users**.



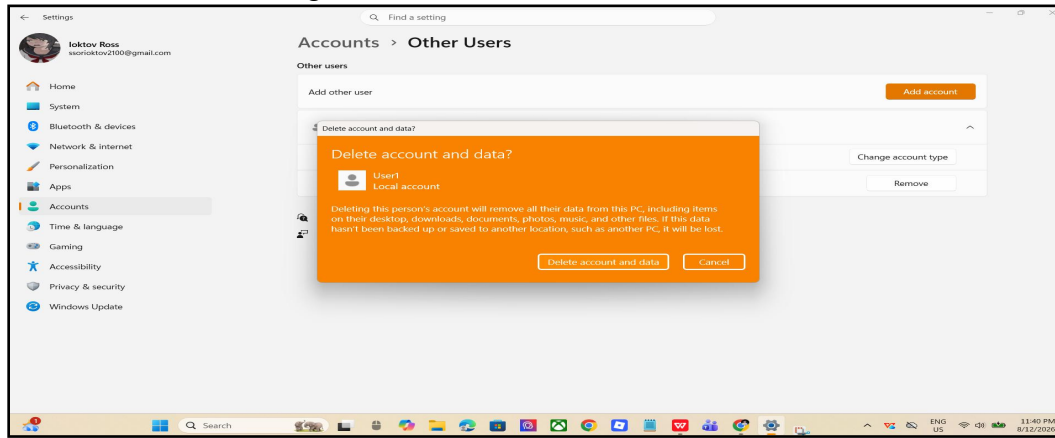
28. Locate the **User1** account. Click on it to expand its options, then click the **Remove account and data** button.



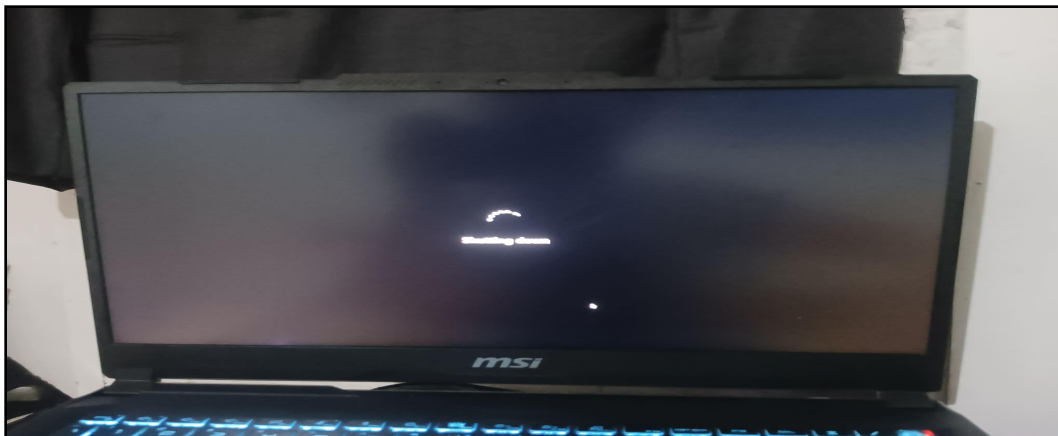
29. In the "Delete account and data?" dialog box, carefully read the warning message, then click the **Delete account and data** button to confirm the permanent removal of the User1 account and all its associated files.



Important Reminder: When configuring a computer or managing accounts, always take your time to read and understand any warnings or prompts displayed in notifications and dialog boxes.



30. Shut down your computer.



V. REFLECTION:

Upon successful completion of "Lab 1.4.5: Managing User Accounts," write a comprehensive reflection (between 150-250 words) addressing the following points:

- **Learning Outcomes:** What new knowledge or skills did you acquire or reinforce regarding the management of user accounts?
- **Challenges and Solutions:** Describe any difficulties or unexpected issues you encountered during the lab. How did you overcome them, or what steps would you take to resolve them in the future?



- **Real-world Relevance:** How do the skills and understanding gained in this lab relate to real-world scenarios, either in your personal life or a professional IT context?
- **Critical Thinking:** If you had to use an internet image for any step, explain why you couldn't perform the action physically and how finding the image contributed to your understanding.

This activity helped us understand the basic process of managing user accounts in an operating system. We learned how to create, manage, and modify user accounts, as well as how account management and permissions help keep a computer system organized and secure.

One challenge we encountered was that the “Family & other users” section was separated from our account settings, which caused confusion because it appeared differently on our system. For the other steps, we also became confused because some of the instructions were not comprehensive enough for us to clearly understand what we needed to do. We overcame these difficulties by carefully reviewing each step and figuring out where the corresponding settings were located.

The skills we gained are relevant to real-world IT because managing user accounts is a common task for system administrators. It is important for controlling access, protecting information, and ensuring that users have the appropriate permissions.

For critical thinking, we did not need to use an internet image for any step. We were able to complete the activities using our own system and the available instructions, even though some parts were confusing.